



TIPS & TRICKS

Screen blanking

 You may have observed pretty often that if you leave your computer idle for about 10 minutes, the screen turns blank. If you wish to disable this setting, start a screen saver. Here is a small tip that can help you.

Using Linux in the console mode, run the following command:

```
#setterm -blank 0
```

And while using the GUI, you can use the command given below:

```
#xset s off
```

To get a screensaver for the GUI, install the 'xscreensaver' package and add the following to your ~/.xsession:

```
xset s off  
xscreensaver &
```

These lines should precede the one that executes your window manager. On my system '.xsession' is:

```
#!/bin/sh  
xset s off  
xscreensaver &  
exec fvwm2
```

For you, it could be something similar.

—Harish Daswani, harishsonu.daswani@gmail.com

Find out the serial number of your machine

 To know the hardware details of a Linux machine, use the command 'dmidecode'. The following command displays the serial number of the machine.

```
[root]# dmidecode -t 1  
# dmidecode 2.9
```

```
SMBIOS 2.33 present.
```

```
Handle 0x0001, DMI type 1, 25 bytes
```

```
System Information
```

```
Manufacturer: IBM
```

```
Product Name: 6225I6S
```

```
Version: IBM CORPORATION
```

```
Serial Number: 99AGW46
```

```
UUID: 800837A1-1F64-0010-807B-DAB48EF9E0D1
```

```
Wake-up Type: Power Switch
```

```
[root]#
```

—Aravindan, aravindanjp01@gmail.com

Control the brightness of your laptop from the command line

 Here is a small trick that can help you to control the brightness of your laptop screen. If we type 'echo 1', the screen will go to the dimmest level. To increase the brightness you can 'echo' a higher value.

```
echo 1 | sudo tee /sys/devices/virtual/backlight/acpi_video0/  
brightness
```

—Kish, realmail@gmail.com

To switch a directory

 If you want to switch to the directory that you were working on previously, i.e., the one prior to the current working directory, you can use the option '-' with the 'cd' command.

Here is an example that will clearly show you how to use '-' and '\$OLDPWD' ...

If you were working in the following directory:

```
/home/user/linux/folder1/work/office
```

...and if you type the command given below:

```
cd /home/user/linux/folder2/  
cd -
```

...it will take you directly to: